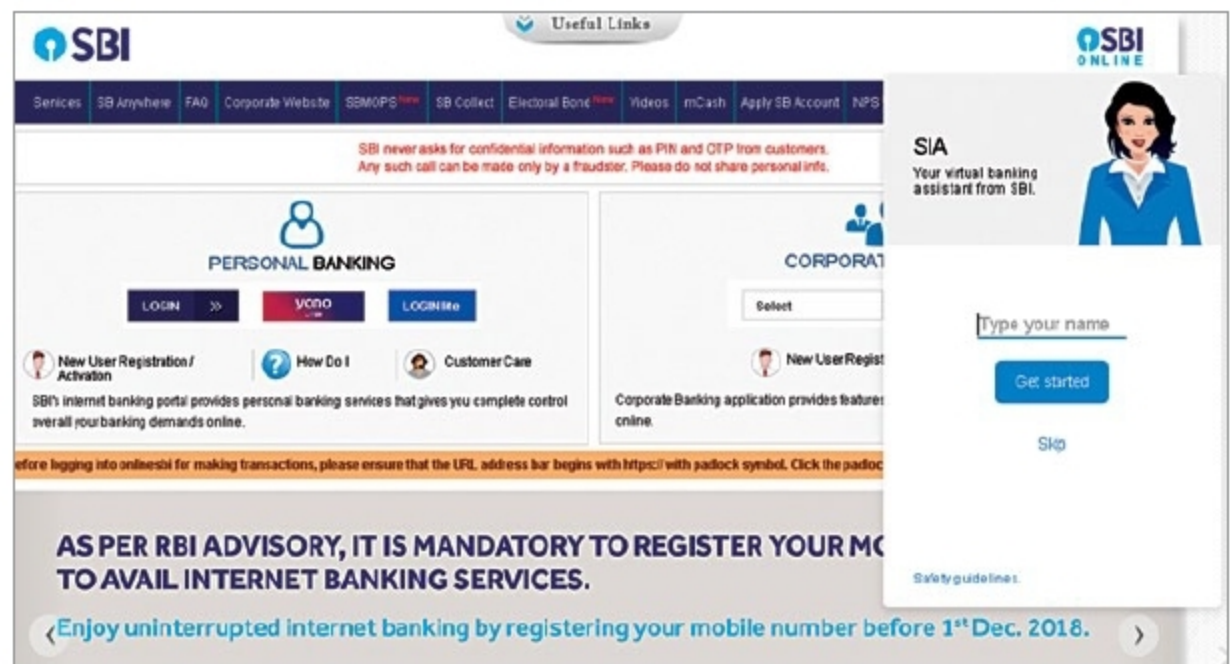


stantial load off SBI's service team. SBI reportedly also uses AI-based camera analytics, which can predict customer satisfaction based on facial recognition. It plans to have a central dashboard to monitor customer support representative ratings based on customer feedback.

HDFC and ICICI banks have also launched their own chatbots, namely, Eva and iPal, respectively. These bots can respond to customer queries. Using machine learning algorithms, the chatbots can learn from historical data to provide more accurate responses, quicker to customers.

AI is playing an important role in Axis Bank's expansion, too. Using machine learning and natural language processing technology, the bank has deployed interactive platforms that can engage in conversations with customers to provide support and solve queries. The bank is integrating AI into its mobile platforms as well.

Canara Bank has employed intelligent robots, namely, Mitra and Candi, in two of its Bengaluru branches for customer support and interaction. While Mitra greets incoming custom-



State Bank of India's SIA

ers and helps them navigate within the office and reach the desired service desk, Candi answers customer queries based on preset questions. Both have support for multiple local languages.

AI improving internal operations

Large banks are already adopting robotic processes for automating repetitive back-office tasks like data entry, message creation, text mining,

currency exchange rate processing and so on. These are using AI-based platforms to create quick and reliable analytics on large volumes of accumulated data. In addition, such platforms can also automate basic banking tasks, freeing employees to focus on important and complex activities.

For instance, reports suggest that automation and AI have helped Axis Bank to improve its overall business processes by over 50 per cent, with reduction of turnaround time in opening saving accounts by 90 per cent.

AI platforms have also helped it reduce fraudulent transactions. The platforms identified that 80 per cent of suspicious transactions were done by just five per cent of their total customers, who they were able to label as high-risk, and take corrective actions.

There are many more such instances where AI is helping banks reduce turnaround time in service, cut down on expenses due to losses and bad transactions, and improve their overall business.

Challenges to overcome

Cyber threats are evolving everyday, which will require banks to have up-to-date security patches and technologies without delay. This will require them to have a strong internal IT team and a well-chosen cyber-security partner. Moreover, to empower AI, accuracy of input data must be ensured. Since Know Your Customer (KYC) data is the primary source of information, banks must invigilate proper

Reducing cyberthreats with AI: A case study

AI has been an important solution for digital security. Cyberthreats are becoming more complex and widespread, making it impossible for basic security systems to thwart breaches. AI platforms are helping banks identify loopholes in their networks and breach attempts, create predictions and prevent cyber-attacks.

Kolkata-headquartered Bandhan Bank recently deployed machine learning-powered threat protection platforms across its endpoints, networks and data centers throughout India. The major initial challenge faced by Bandhan Bank was lack of clear visibility of its IT assets across regions and frequent malware attacks leading to an overloaded helpdesk and reduced customer satisfaction.

To address these challenges, the bank adopted software solutions that can look into each of the areas of vulnerabilities. It partnered with Trend Micro to adopt three platforms, given below.

To secure endpoints and user activity, Bandhan Bank installed 7000 units of a machine-learning powered tool, called OfficeScan.

For centralised data visibility to scan and identify targeted cyber-attacks, it hired a platform called Deep Discovery Inspector.

And to further increase overall security, it installed a custom sandboxing suite called Deep Discovery Analyser.

These platforms utilise techniques like static analysis, behaviour analysis, heuristic analysis, lateral movement detection, Web filtering, file reputation, command-and-control behaviour detection and custom sandbox analysis in their operations.

The tools detect, identify and eliminate threats like malware, ransomware, document exploits, phishing, trojans and more. In addition, these allow auto-upgrade of security features based on evolution patterns of threats.

Initially launched as a proof-of-concept, the bank experienced substantially reduced user complaints, an increase in uptime by 95 per cent and an overall safer service with clear visibility of networks and endpoints.